

Republic Is Not Democracy

Representation Without Participation Is Oligarchy

Return political power to the people



The Core Deception

- Voting is not ruling
- Representation is not participation
- Public interest is defined from above
- The people become spectators
- Republic is branded as democracy

1 vote

Political equality is necessary, not sufficient

Democratic appearance

elections · parties · parliament

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Oligarchic command

agenda · law · enforcement

Argument 1 · Elections Are Not Rule

- Res publica
- Public interest controlled by officeholders
- Elections choose rulers
- Citizens do not set the agenda
- No direct legislative power
- No continuous popular sovereignty



Aristotle · Rousseau · Dahl

Argument 2 · Representation Replaces Participation

- Parties select candidates
- Voters ratify options
- Representatives obey party line
- Government dominates parliament
- The people lose command

The People

source of legitimacy



Parties

candidate filter



Parliament

party discipline

policy descends after voters ratify options

Argument 3 · Oligarchy Reproduces Itself

- Party machines
- Economic oligarchy
- Media influence
- State appointments
- Weak accountability

50/100

Corruption perception score · Greece

Access becomes power

- party entry
- media visibility
- state appointments

Accountability Breakdown

86/180

Press freedom rank · Greece

- Institutional pressure
- Wiretapping concerns
- SLAPP pressure
- Information control
- Accountability deficit

55.05

Press freedom score

Satisfaction · Constitutional Makeover

- Citizen-initiated referenda
- Popular legislative initiative
- Recall of officials
- Independent justice
- Transparent public finance
- Anti-corruption prosecution

Power to the People

not symbolic consent · real constitutional authority

referendum · initiative · recall · audit · justice

Visualization · Two Political Orders

Republic as Oligarchy

- Voting ritual
- Party command
- Elite bargaining
- Opaque decisions
- Managed people

power sits above citizens

Constitutional Democracy

- Citizen rule
- Direct mandate
- Recall
- Public audit
- Accountable institutions

power returns to citizens

Action · Power to the People

- Reject voting-only democracy
- Demand constitutional reform
- Demand popular referenda
- Demand recall powers
- Demand legislative initiative



Representation is not participation.

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